

THESIS II. FINALS.
RIN KIM.

Loops

Rin Kim

I am a Korean (🇰🇷) designer,
currently in New York (🗽),
interested in how people interact
with technology.

I hold a BFA in Visual Design and
a BA in French.



PALAIS GARNIER
PARIS, FRANCE
2017

“The struggle itself toward the heights is enough to fill a man’s heart. One must imagine Sisyphus happy.”

**I found myself
in a loop.**

Involuntary

Loops

Continuous cycle of activities and circumstances that we were compelled to engage in or adhere to.

Chosen

Thresholds

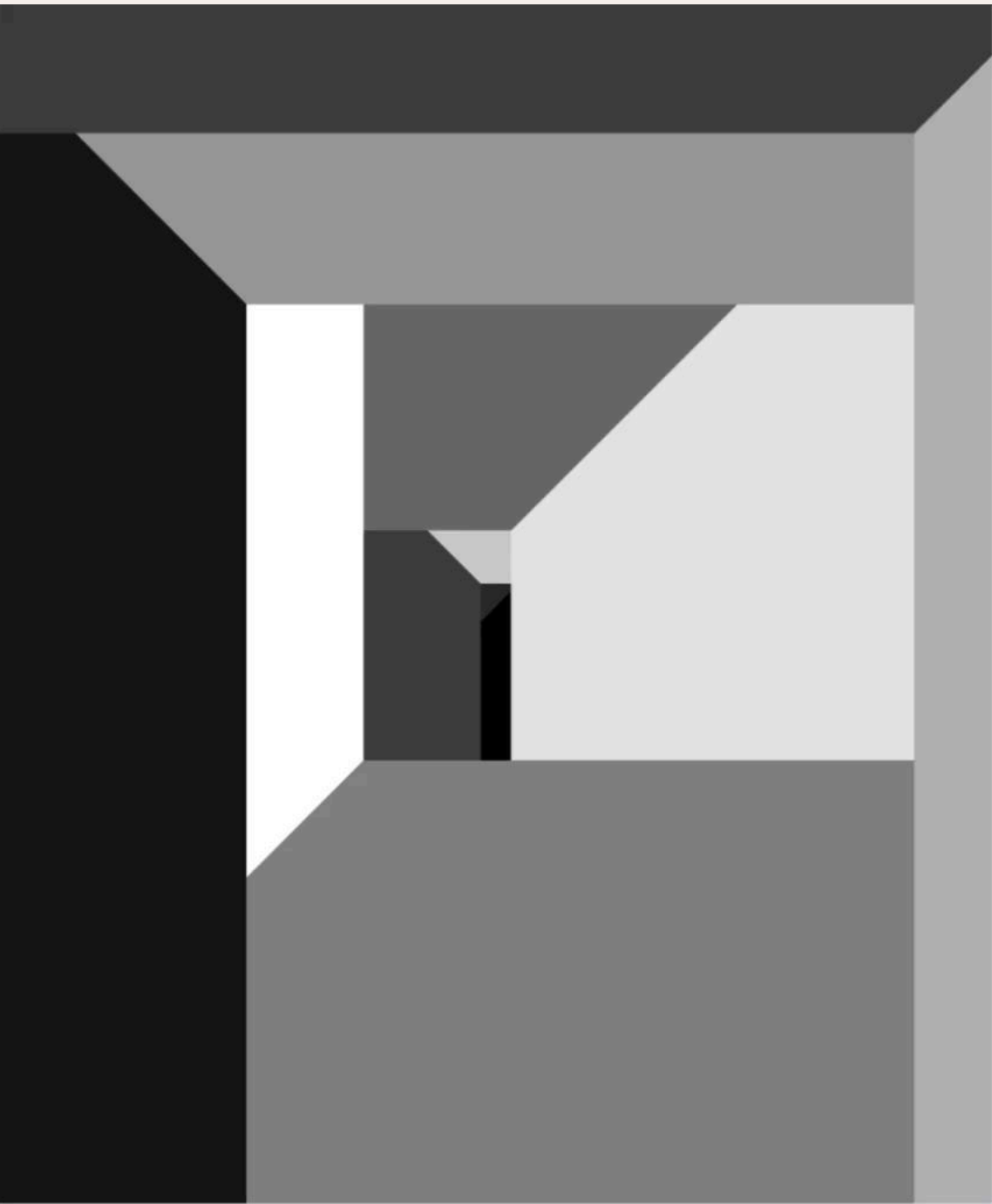
Autonomy to determine our actions and interpretations within these circumstances.

Code = Loop

```
for (let i = 0; i < 5; i++) {  
  console.log(i);  
}
```

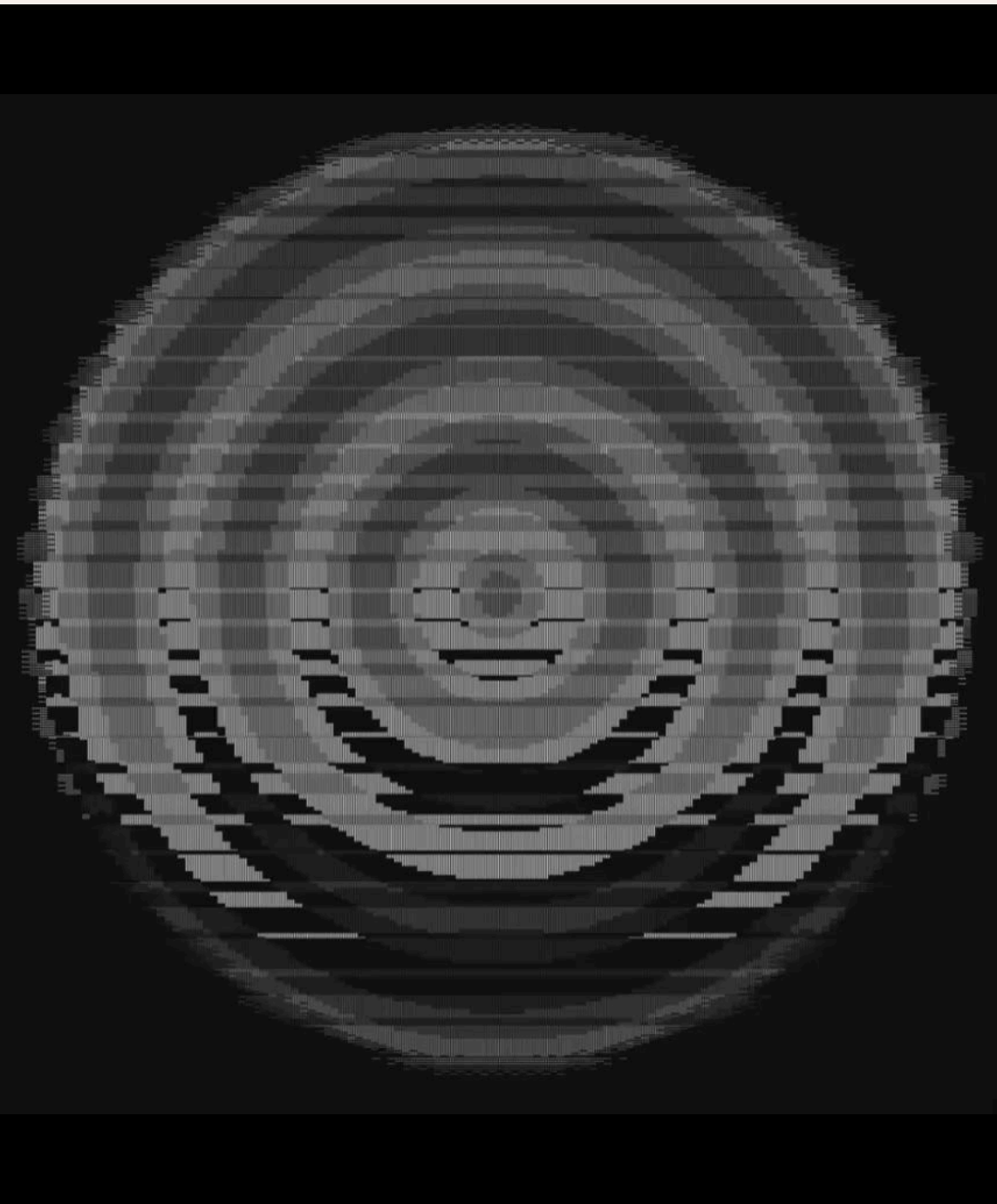
Rafaël Rozendaal

Irregular loops of basic shapes through code

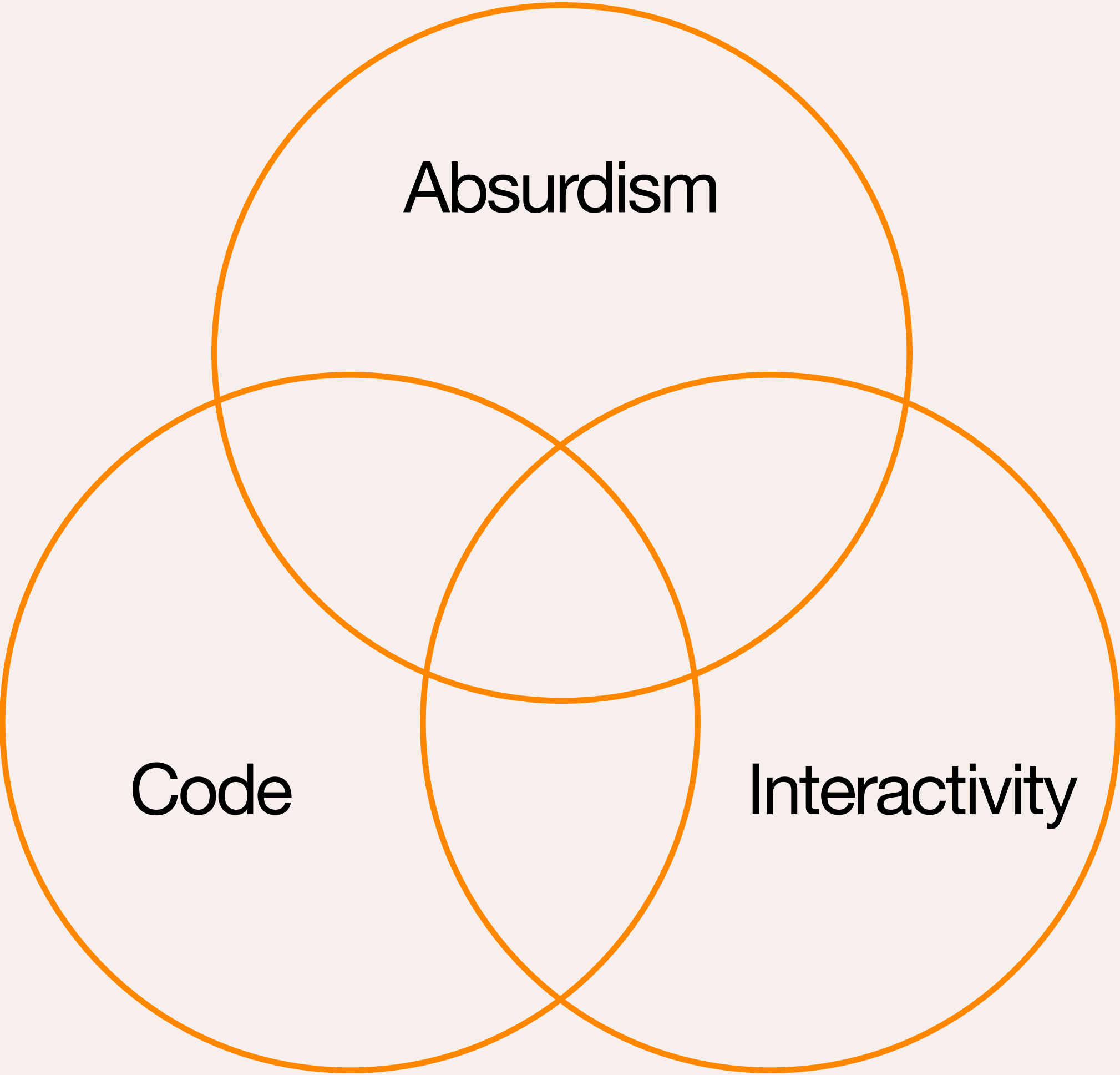


Zach Lieberman

A generative patterns through code



Interaction and Reflection



What narratives emerge from
the tension between
involuntary loops
and chosen thresholds?

What narratives emerge from
the tension between
involuntary loops
and chosen thresholds?

Loops

A collection of digital artworks on
involuntary loops and chosen thresholds.

Myth of Sisyphus

A direct response to Camus's retelling of the myth of Sisyphus. An orange circle represents the boulder, and a dark triangular slope suggests the hill. Visitors can push the boulder up the slope either with a mouse or with their hand tracked through the webcam.



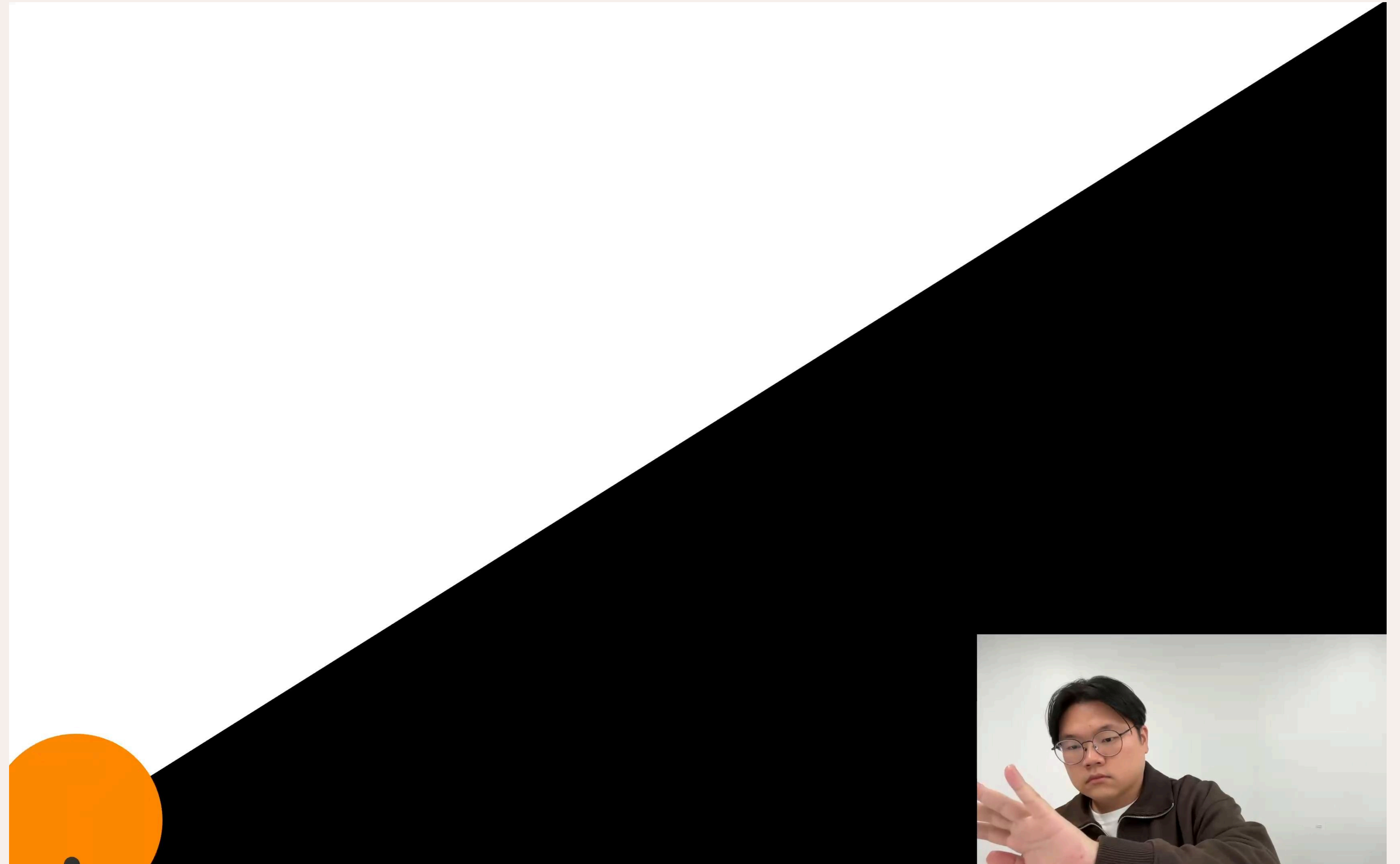
LOOP 1.

Interaction

- Mouse drag
- Hand pose sensing through webcam

Testing Results

- Different levels of engagement
- Hand pose sensing through webcam



Doors

A door is one of the most ordinary things we encounter, yet every doorway marks a small shift in role and identity: office to home, public to private, one phase of life to the next. The alternating passage through frames becomes a picture of continual transformation, where every apparent ending is simply another beginning, and the viewer is kept inside the question of who they are becoming as they keep passing through.



LOOP 2.

Interaction

- Changes perspective with face position relative to the screen

Testing Results

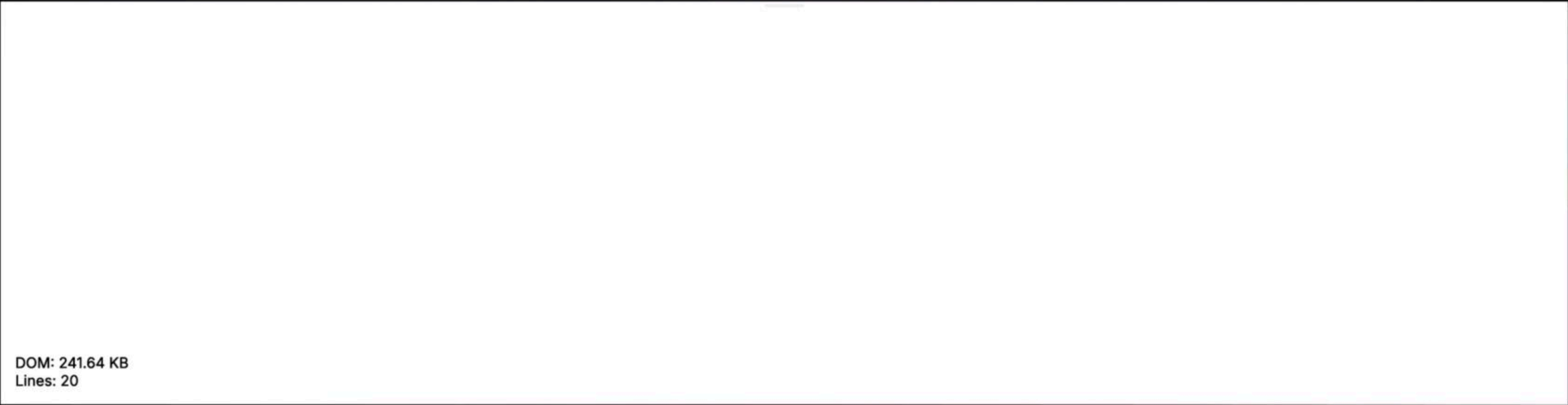
- Frustration of slow speed
- People believing their walking triggered the walking on the screen



Doors
Interaction Video

Accumulation

Accumulation is a digital reflection of a physical process: drawing black circles on a canvas, covering them with white, and repeating. What first seems like a meaningless act of repetition leaves small traces behind, marks that build up with each iteration. After several rounds, the black circles begin to show through the white paint, the surface growing darker, thicker and uneven. When all the layers are complete, the canvas appears blank again, but it carries a new density. Its weight reveals the history beneath the surface: an accumulation of effort, time and the residue of every action that came before. *Accumulation* shows how code gains weight through the DOM as new lines of code is added on top of each other.



Blank Canvas

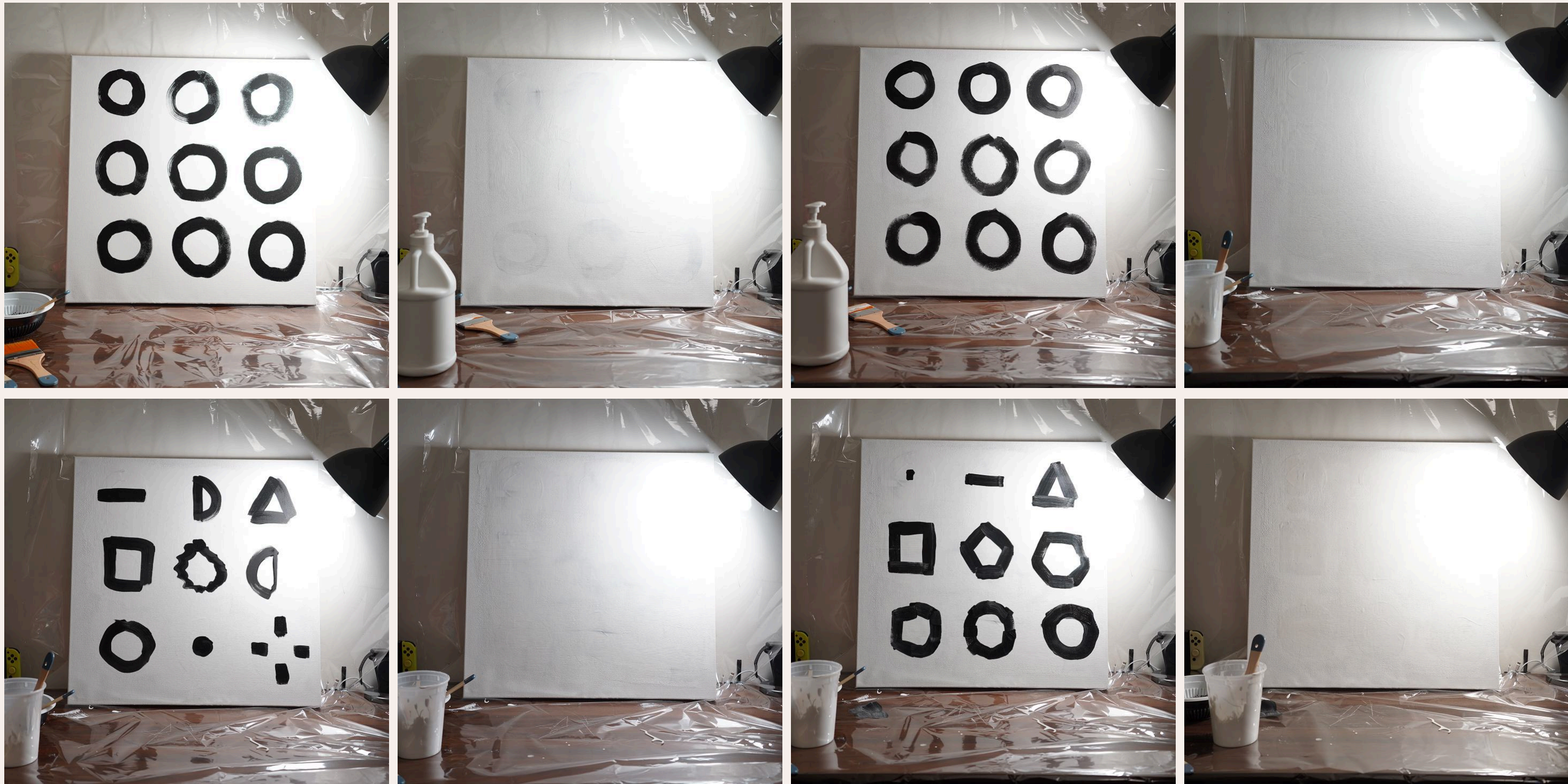
Iteration from left to right, top to bottom.

Interaction

- Clicking on screen changes diameter of circle and flips colors

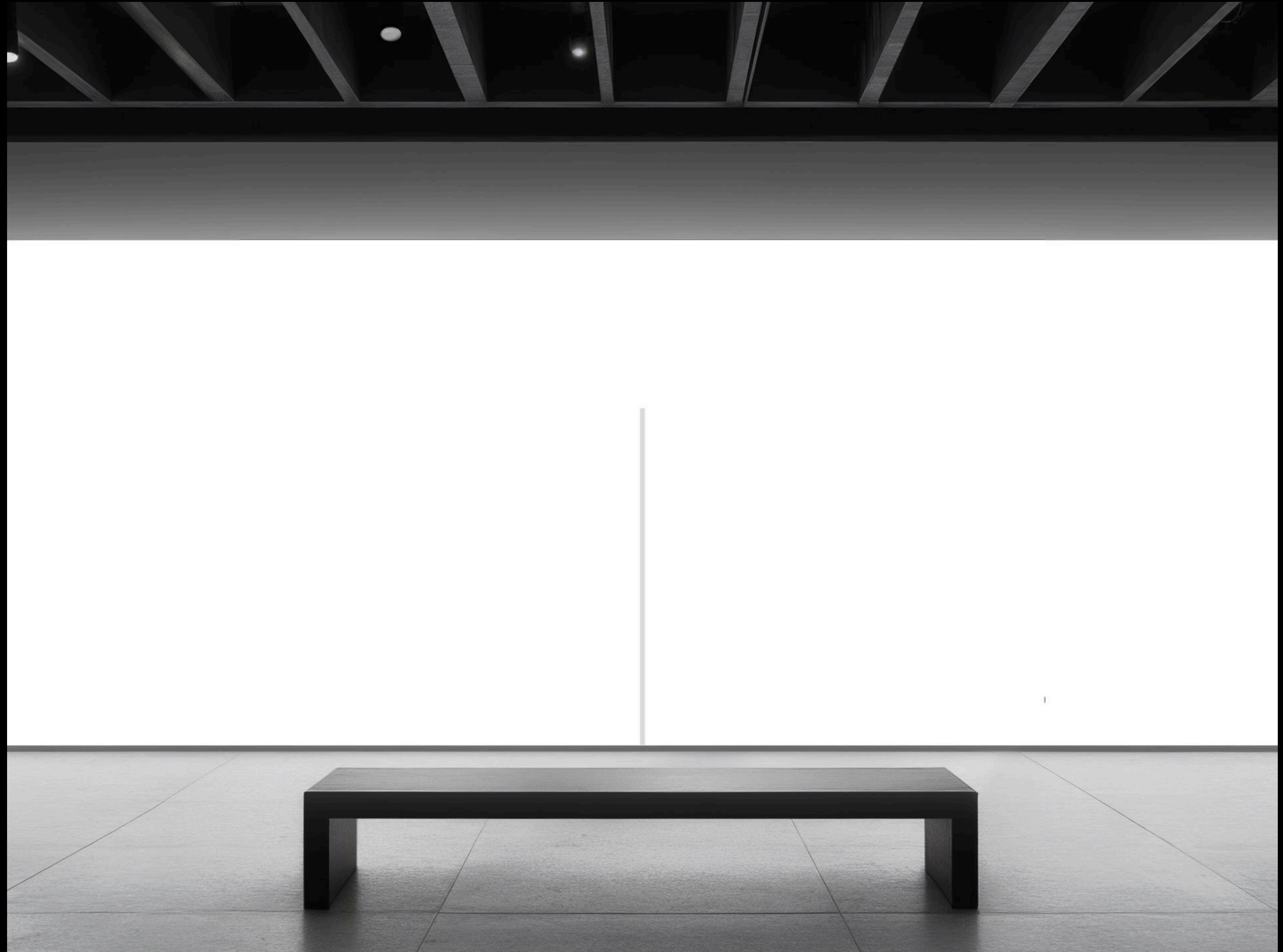
Testing Results

- Meaning wasn't as direct as other projects in the collection
- Needed knowledge on coding to fully understand



Incense

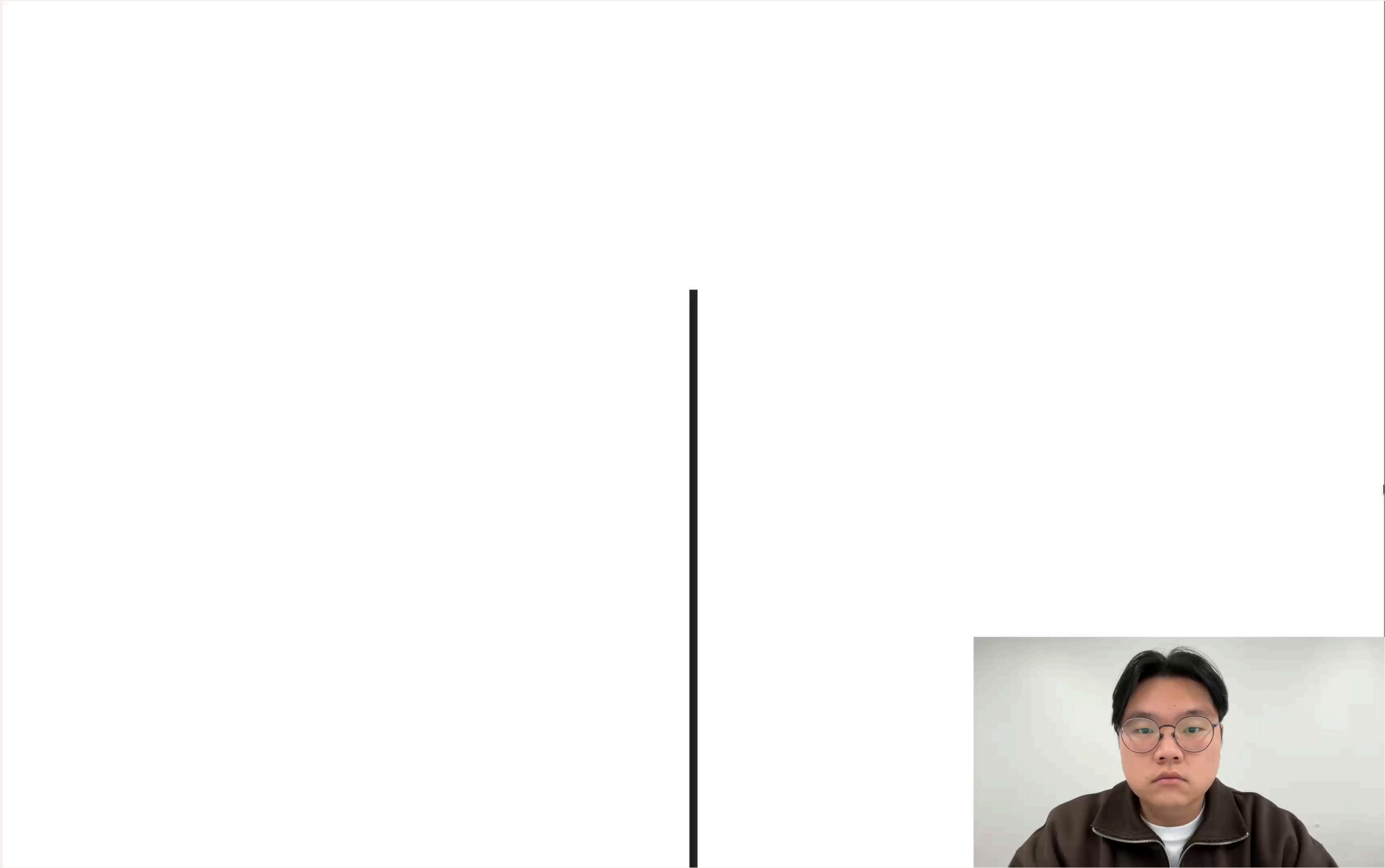
Incense is a digital representation of a burning incense stick as a connection between life and death. The smoke changes directions based on the position of the viewer, just as it would change direction based on the wind of people moving by.



LOOP 5.

Interaction

- Smoke shifts in the direction of the viewer's face location on screen



Incense
Interaction Video

Meaningful/ Meaningless

Meaningful/Meaningless comes from an observation from a drawing activity where people were asked to draw patterns of “Absurdity” and “Meaningfulness”. People drew “Absurdity in randomized doodles, and “Meaningfulness” in a more constructed repetition. However, the randomness felt like it had more freedom.



김인종 1998-, <무의미>

2025, 디스플레이에 코드, 화면 너비 x 화면 높이

Rin Kim 1998-, Meaningless

2025, JavaScript on <canvas>, View width x View height

김인종 1998-, <유의미>

2025, 디스플레이에 코드, 화면 너비 x 화면 높이

Rin Kim 1998-, Meaningful

2025, JavaScript on <canvas>, View width x View height

Drawing as elicitation

Patterns drawn on Absurdity / Meaningfulness / Error / Success

Testing Results

- Viewers focusing more on the randomized sketch to see where the circle goes next
- Viewers debating on what they think is more meaningful



Not the Same Sun

Work in progress.



Fountain

Work in progress.



<https://loops.rin.kim>

Inviting viewers to reflect on their own loops and thresholds.

By experiencing these digital loops, I hope the audience will pause to consider the patterns they find themselves repeating, and the subtle moments where they can decide how to interpret or respond. The work suggests that rather than resisting these loops, we can accept their presence, embrace their absurdity, and ultimately regain a sense of agency.

Demo @ ACM TEI 26

March 7th - March 11th

The paper for The Loops was accepted to the Student Design Challenge of TEI 26.

[Link to ACM Digital Library](#)



The Loops: An Interactive Artwork on Reclaiming Agency in Involuntary Repetition

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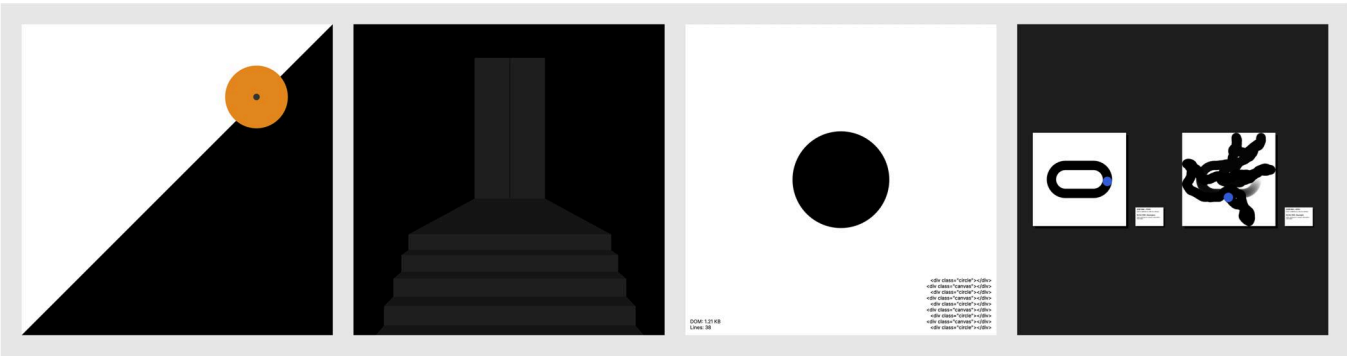


Figure 1: 4 Sketches from The Loops

Abstract

People move through many forms of involuntary repetition, from daily routines to scrolling through screens, often without noticing how these loops shape their sense of agency. When they do become aware of them, repetition can feel empty and compulsory, and it is difficult to see where choice or control might appear. This paper presents The Loops, a collection of interactive artwork on digital screens that uses simple repeated interaction to make this question tangible. Each sketch creates an abstract situation that repeats without a beginning, progress, or ending, and can be engaged through motion sensing, touch, or mouse input. The Loops explores the potential and role of interactive artwork as both a site of reflection and a medium for applied philosophy.

CCS Concepts

• **Applied computing** → **Media arts**; • **Human-centered computing** → **Activity centered design**; *Gestural input*.

Keywords

Reflective Design, Interactive Design, Media Art, Digital Art, Applied Philosophy

ACM Reference Format:
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Tangible, Embedded, and Embodied Interaction (TEI '26), March 08–11, 2026, Chicago, IL, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3731459.3786210>

1 Introduction

In contemporary life, many forms of repetition are not chosen in any strong sense [3, 4]. Work schedules, institutional routines, and personal responsibilities organize much of the day, while a second layer of digital habits forms around them: scrolling through feeds, swiping left and right, and clearing notifications in ongoing loops that are easy to enter and hard to leave [4, 10, 14]. Most of the time, these cycles stay in the background of attention. When they do become visible, they can feel empty and compulsory, and it is still unclear where a person might find a sense of choice or control inside them [13].

Studies in reflective design argue that interactive systems do more than support tasks [2, 6]. They also shape how people live and understand themselves, and can therefore be designed to invite reflection rather than only efficiency [8]. In this view, reflection means bringing usually unexamined aspects of experience into awareness so that they can become available for deliberate choice, and can be treated as a primary outcome of design [16]. Read alongside philosophical accounts of absurdity and repetition [3, 11], such as Camus's writing on Sisyphus and imposed routines, this suggests a role for interactive artifacts as a kind of applied philosophy: not to explain ideas, but to set up situations in which questions of involuntary repetition and agency can be felt and reflected on.

The Loops is an interactive artwork developed from this intersection. It consists of a collection of simple looping sketches that run on digital screens of many sizes. Each sketch constructs an abstract situation that repeats without a clear beginning, progress,

Setup plan for pop-up show

Objects

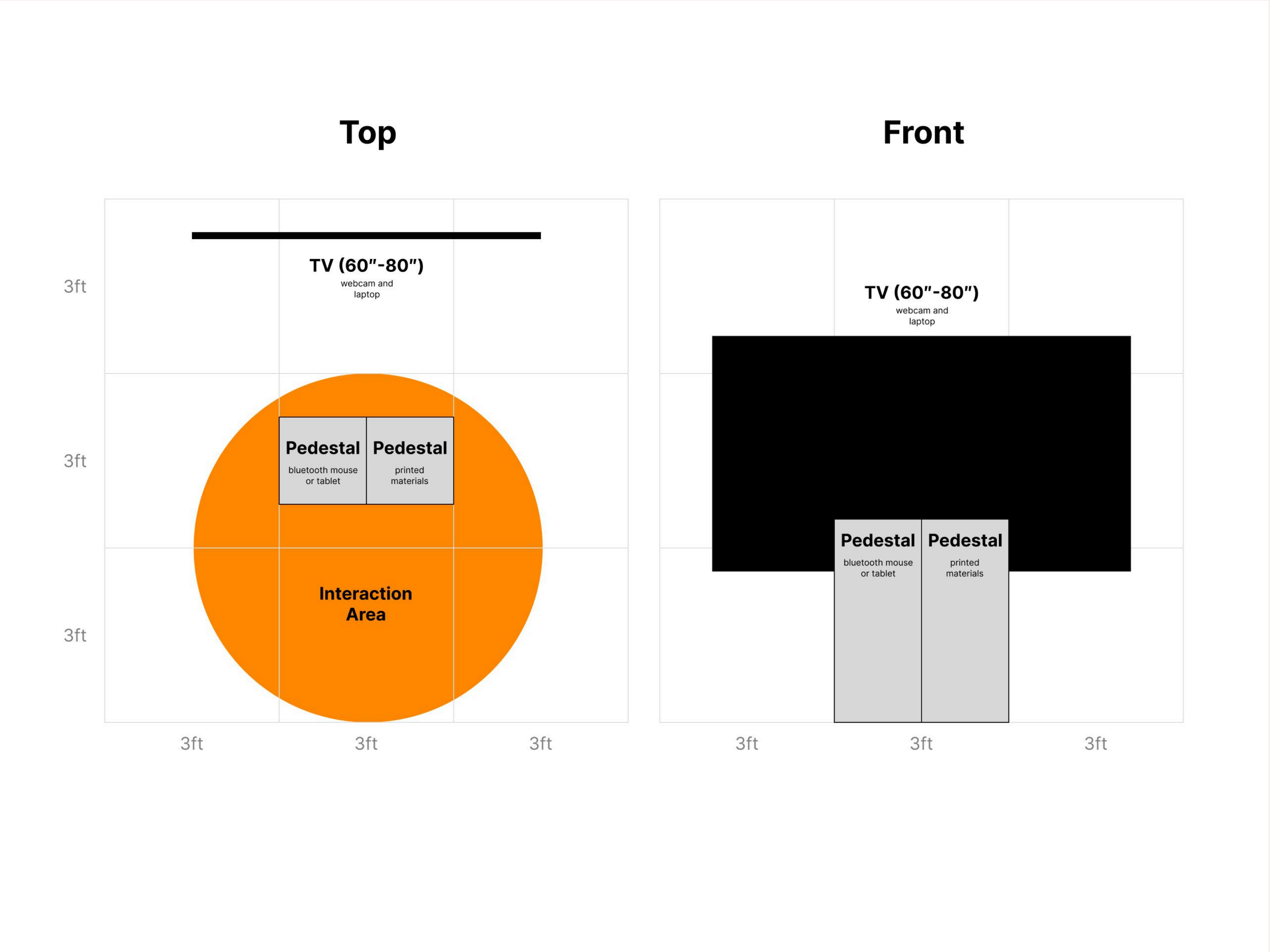
- Large TV (60"-80")
- Webcam (attached to TV)
- Pedestal
- Tablet

TV

- Runs the project

Tablet

- Controller for navigation
- Guide for interaction



Thank you